

Chapter 6: Responding to Social Media Messages

Introduction

Customers reach out to business in multiple ways to raise their queries and concerns



Source: BoldDesk

One strong and flourishing medium is social media. Social media is a two-way communication channel where customers expect quick and professional responses. A well-crafted response can enhance brand reputation, build customer trust, and even turn negative experiences into positive ones. Businesses that engage effectively on social media tend to see higher customer retention and brand loyalty.

Recent Stats:

76% of customers expect a response on social media within 24 hours.

40% of consumers prefer social media over phone or email for customer service.

Companies that respond to queries quickly on social media see a **20-40% increase in customer satisfaction**.

Handling Customer Queries Professionally

Customers reach out on social media with various inquiries, including product details, service issues, pricing, or troubleshooting. A professional approach ensures clear, polite, and helpful communication.



Source: Upwork

1. Key Best Practices:

- ✓ Respond within 1-2 hours for urgent queries, and within 24 hours for general questions.
- ✓ Use a friendly and empathetic tone.
- ✓ Provide clear and concise information.
- ✓ Direct users to helpful resources like FAQs or support links.

Example:

Customer: "Hey, I ordered a laptop from your website but haven't received any updates on the delivery. Can you check?"

✓ Good Response:

"Hi [Name], we're sorry for the delay! Please DM us your order number, and we'll check the status for you right away. 🚀"

Example:

Customer: "Does your app support Android 10?"

✓ **Good Response:** "Yes! Our app is fully compatible with Android 10 and later versions. Need help setting it up? Let us know! 😊"

[Exercise 1]: Draft Engaging Response

Rewrite the response below to sound more professional and engaging:

"Check the FAQ section on our site for answers. We don't have time to reply to every question."

[Exercise 2]: Draft Informative Response

A customer is asking about your product's warranty policy on Twitter. Write a response that provides helpful information and encourages further engagement.

Writing Appropriate Responses for Different Situations

Your response should be tailored to the situation.

1. Tailoring Responses:

- ✓ Address customers by **name** when possible.
- ✓ Adjust tone based on **situation and brand personality**.
- ✓ If needed, **move sensitive conversations to DMs**.

 There's something wrong with your product. It has to be some bug that deleted all my settings and now [the product] doesn't work properly. I want a refund! Hi! I'm sorry, but this case doesn't fall for [Company name] refund policy [link]. Thus, I cannot offer you an account credit.  Poor customer service	 There's something wrong with your product. It has to be some bug that deleted all my settings and now [the product] doesn't work properly. I want a refund! Hi! I understand how this can be frustrating and really sorry about that. But I can't provide you with a refund because this bug can be fixed easily. I'd be happy to help you configure your settings again.  Pro customer service message
 Hi! I've purchased your product two months ago, and it works great! But it could be better if it had a [feature]. I think it will be helpful for many clients. Can you add it in the next update? Hello [First name]! Thanks for your feedback, we are really glad you liked the product. Moreover, your idea sounds great. Can you provide more details to share with our product team? It will help to prioritize their resources, so you could see the results faster. I'll back you as soon as [the feature] will be ready and you'll be the first one to enjoy its advantages.  An example of a customer service scenario script if 'YES'	 Hi! I've purchased your product two months ago, and it works great! But it could be better if it had a [feature]. I think it will be helpful for many clients. Can you add it in the next update? Hello [First name]! Thanks for sharing your idea, it's fascinating. Many of our customers agree with you. It's already in our backlog, and I'll add your vote to move it further. Because of limited resources, we can't implement it in the next update. But, I'll notify you when we're ready to present the [new feature]. In the meantime, you can try [an alternative solution]. Do you need my help with it?  An example of a customer service scenario script if 'NO'

Source: Dashly

2. Response As Per Situations

Here are different scenarios and the best way to respond:

Situation	Example Response
General Inquiry	"Hi [Name], great question! Yes, we offer free shipping on orders above \$50. Let us know if you need more details. 😊"
Product Recommendation	"Hi [Name], based on your needs, we recommend our [Product Name]. It's great for [mention benefits]. Let us know if you'd like a special discount! 🎁"
Service Delay	"We understand your concern, [Name]. Our team is working hard to resolve the issue, and we'll update you soon. Thanks for your patience! 🙏"
Feature Request	"Thanks for your suggestion, [Name]! We love hearing from our customers. We'll share this with our development team for consideration. 🚀"
Product Inquiry	"Great question, [Name]! Our latest model features a longer battery life and faster charging . Let us know if you'd like a discount code! 🎁"
Feature Request	"That's an awesome idea, [Name]! We'll share it with our product team. Stay tuned for updates! 🚀"
Late Delivery	"We're really sorry, [Name]! Your order is on its way, and we'll share the tracking details shortly. Thanks for your patience!"

Exercises:

[Exercise 3]: Draft Response To Inquiry

A customer asks if your online course includes live Q&A sessions. Write a response that highlights the course benefits.

[Exercise 4]: Draft Polite Response

Your company receives a comment requesting a feature that's not currently available. Craft a polite and engaging response.

Managing Negative Feedback Effectively

Negative feedback is inevitable, but how you handle it can turn a dissatisfied customer into a loyal one.

1. Do's & Don'ts of Response to Negative Feedback:

- ✓ Acknowledge the issue quickly.
- ✓ Apologize if necessary, even if the mistake wasn't intentional.
- ✓ Offer a solution or alternative.
- ✓ Take the conversation to DMs if needed.
- ✗ Avoid deleting negative comments unless they contain hate speech or spam.



Source: HubSpot

2. Best Practices:

- ✓ Stay **calm and professional**—never argue or get defensive.
- ✓ **Acknowledge** the complaint and apologize if necessary.
- ✓ **Offer** a solution or next steps.
- ✓ Move the conversation to private channels if **sensitive**.

3. Common Negative Reviews & Professional Responses

Negative Review

“This is the worst experience ever! I never got my refund”

Effective Response

“Hi [Name], we’re sorry to hear this! Let’s fix it ASAP. Please DM us your order details, and we’ll look into it right away”

Negative Review

"Terrible service! My order was supposed to arrive last week, and I still haven't received it!"

"Your product stopped working after a week. This is unacceptable!"

"Terrible customer service! No one replied to my email for days."

"This is the worst app ever! So many bugs, and it crashes all the time."

"Shipping took forever. I won't be ordering from you again."

"I was overcharged on my bill! This is a scam!"

"Your food delivery was late, and the meal was cold. Disappointed!"

"Your customer support chatbot is useless. I need to speak to a real person!"

"The size I ordered doesn't fit, and now I have to pay for return shipping?"

"Your website keeps crashing. I can't complete my purchase!"

Effective Response

"We're really sorry for the delay, [Name]. Please send us a DM with your order details, and we'll get this resolved ASAP. We appreciate your patience!"

"We're really sorry to hear that, [Name]. That's not the experience we want for our customers. Please DM us your order details, and we'll resolve this for you ASAP!"

"We sincerely apologize for the delay, [Name]. We're experiencing a high volume of inquiries, but we're here to help! Please share your ticket number, and we'll prioritize your request."

"Hi [Name], we appreciate your feedback and understand your frustration. Our team is working on updates to fix these issues. Could you DM us more details? We'd love to improve your experience!"

"We're so sorry for the delay, [Name]. We know how frustrating that can be. If you DM us your order details, we'll check with our shipping partner and make it right!"

"Hi [Name], we take billing issues very seriously. Please send us a DM with your order details, and we'll review it immediately to resolve the issue."

"We're truly sorry for this, [Name]. This isn't the experience we want for our customers. Could you DM us your order number? We'd like to make it up to you!"

"We hear you, [Name], and we apologize for any frustration. Our team is available to assist you! Please DM us, and a representative will personally help you."

"Hi [Name], we understand how frustrating that can be. We'd love to help! Please DM us your order number, and we'll find a solution that works for you."

"Thanks for letting us know, [Name]. We're looking into it now! Could you try clearing your cache or using another browser? If the issue persists, DM us so we can assist further."

Negative Review

"I subscribed to your service, but I can't cancel my membership!"

Effective Response

"Hi [Name], we're sorry for any inconvenience. You can manage your subscription in your account settings. If you need help, DM us, and we'll guide you through the process."

This structured approach ensures that **negative feedback is acknowledged, solutions are offered, and brand reputation is maintained.**

[Exercise 5]: Rewrite Response To Negative Feedback

Rewrite this response to be more effective:

"We're sorry, but it's not our fault. Contact support if you have issues."

[Exercise 6]: Draft Response To Negative Feedback

A customer complains that your mobile app keeps crashing. Write a response that acknowledges the issue and provides a solution.

Maintaining Brand Voice in Responses

Firstly, why brand voice matters?

- ✓ A **consistent tone** builds brand identity.
- ✓ Align responses with your **brand personality** (formal, friendly, humorous).
- ✓ Keep messaging **clear, concise, and engaging**.

Your responses should reflect the brand's personality—whether it's professional, friendly, humorous, or formal.

1. Example Responses by Brand Type:

Professional (Banking/Finance):

"Hi [Name], thank you for reaching out. We've escalated your concern and will update you soon. Let us know if you need further assistance."

Friendly (E-commerce/Fashion):

"Oh no, [Name]! That's not what we want. 😞 DM us your order details, and we'll fix this right away!"

Humorous (Entertainment):

"Oops! Looks like our delivery elves took a detour. 🧑‍🎅 DM us your details, and we'll bring them back on track!"

[Exercise 7]: Rewrite Response

Rewrite this response to match a fun and youthful brand voice:

"Your refund is being processed and will take 5-7 business days."

[Exercise 8]: Draft Response

Your company has a serious and professional brand image. Write a formal response to a customer asking about a policy update.

[Exercise 9]: Handling Customer Queries:

Rewrite this response to make it more professional and helpful:

"Your order is delayed. We don't know when it will arrive."

[Exercise 10]: Writing Response for Different Situations:

Draft a response for a customer who wants to return a product but doesn't have the original receipt.

[Exercise 11]: Managing Negative Feedback:

A customer complains on Twitter that your app keeps crashing. Write a response that acknowledges the issue and provides a solution.

[Exercise 12]: Maintaining Brand Voice:

Your brand is a youthful, energetic fitness company. Rewrite this response to match the brand voice:

"Thank you for reaching out. Your refund is being processed and will take 5-7 business days."

Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

What is the ideal response time for customer queries on social media?

- a) Within 1 hour
- b) Within 24 hours
- c) Within 48 hours
- d) Within a week

Answer: A

How should brands handle negative feedback on social media?

- a) Ignore it
- b) Delete the comment
- c) Acknowledge the issue and provide a resolution
- d) Argue with the customer

Answer: C

What is the best way to handle a customer inquiry when you don't have an immediate answer?

- a) Say "We don't know" and end the conversation
- b) Provide an estimated response time and follow up later
- c) Ignore the question until you find an answer
- d) Redirect the customer to a general FAQ page

Answer: B

Why is it important to maintain a consistent brand voice in responses?

- a) It helps build a recognizable brand identity
- b) It makes customer interactions robotic
- c) It reduces customer queries
- d) It avoids accountability

Answer: A

What is the most professional way to respond to a late delivery complaint?

- a) "Not our fault, check with the courier."
- b) "We're sorry for the delay. DM us your order details, and we'll check for updates."
- c) "These things happen, please be patient."
- d) "Just wait a bit longer, it will arrive soon."

Answer: B

What should you avoid when handling customer complaints?

- a) Deleting negative comments
- b) Apologizing and resolving the issue
- c) Offering alternatives
- d) Taking conversations to DMs if necessary

Answer: A

When should a business move a public conversation to DMs?

- a) When the issue is minor
- b) When private information is required
- c) When the customer is praising the brand
- d) When there are too many comments

Answer: B

Which of these is NOT a best practice for responding to queries?

- a) Being clear and concise
- b) Using an empathetic tone
- c) Replying only once and never following up
- d) Providing helpful resources when needed

Answer: C

How can humor be used effectively in responses?

- a) By mocking the customer's issue

- b) By making light of complaints
- c) By aligning with the brand voice appropriately
- d) By using excessive emojis in serious matters

Answer: C

What percentage of consumers expect businesses to respond on social media within 24 hours?

- a) 40%
- b) 50%
- c) 60%
- d) 76%

Answer: D